

VERA GUTTENBERGER

UX DESIGN - SAMPLE PROJECTS

vera.guttenberger@gmail.com
[linkedin.com/in/vera-guttenberger](https://www.linkedin.com/in/vera-guttenberger)
vguttenberger.github.io



Hi, I'm **Vera Guttenberger** – Senior Product Designer based in Boston

🖥️ I currently work at Klaviyo, an email and SMS marketing automation platform, with a built-in CDP. I am on the Editors team, focusing on our drag-and-drop email template editor. I had previously also worked on our Onboarding and SMS teams.

🇮🇹 Previously, I worked at Deloitte's InsightStudio, designing data visualizations and other analytics capabilities for clients in a variety of industries.

🎓 Before that, I graduated with a B.S. in Computer Science and in Cognitive and Brain Sciences from Tufts University.

klaviyo™

Senior Product Designer

2021- present

Deloitte.

*UX Designer and
Front-end Developer*

2019-2021



*B.S. in Computer Science and
Cognitive & Brain Sciences*

2015-2018

PROJECT 1

PERSONALIZATION

Improving the ability for customers to use dynamic content in their messaging through the editors by redesigning the UI for selecting personalization options.

Overview

Multiple iterations of enabling users to easily add personalized, dynamic content to their messaging.

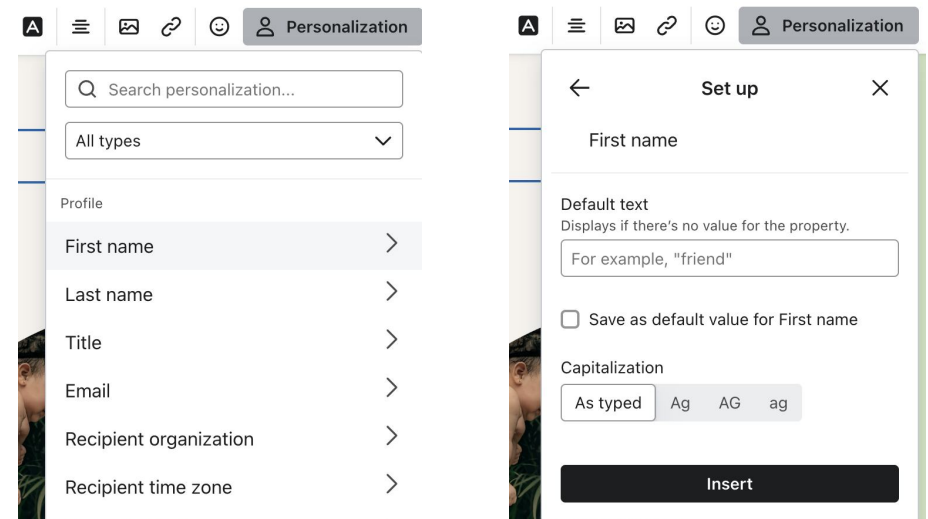
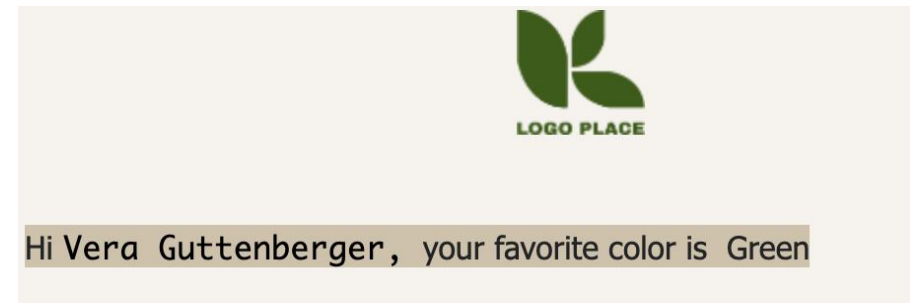
PROBLEM

Personalization is a vital part of messaging, as emails with personalization perform significantly better than those without.

Users want to personalize their messaging (email and SMS) content to their audience, but doing so effectively requires knowledge of Django syntax. Users often get stuck because they do not know where to begin, or don't know the correct syntax to use - making personalization a cumbersome and time-consuming process.

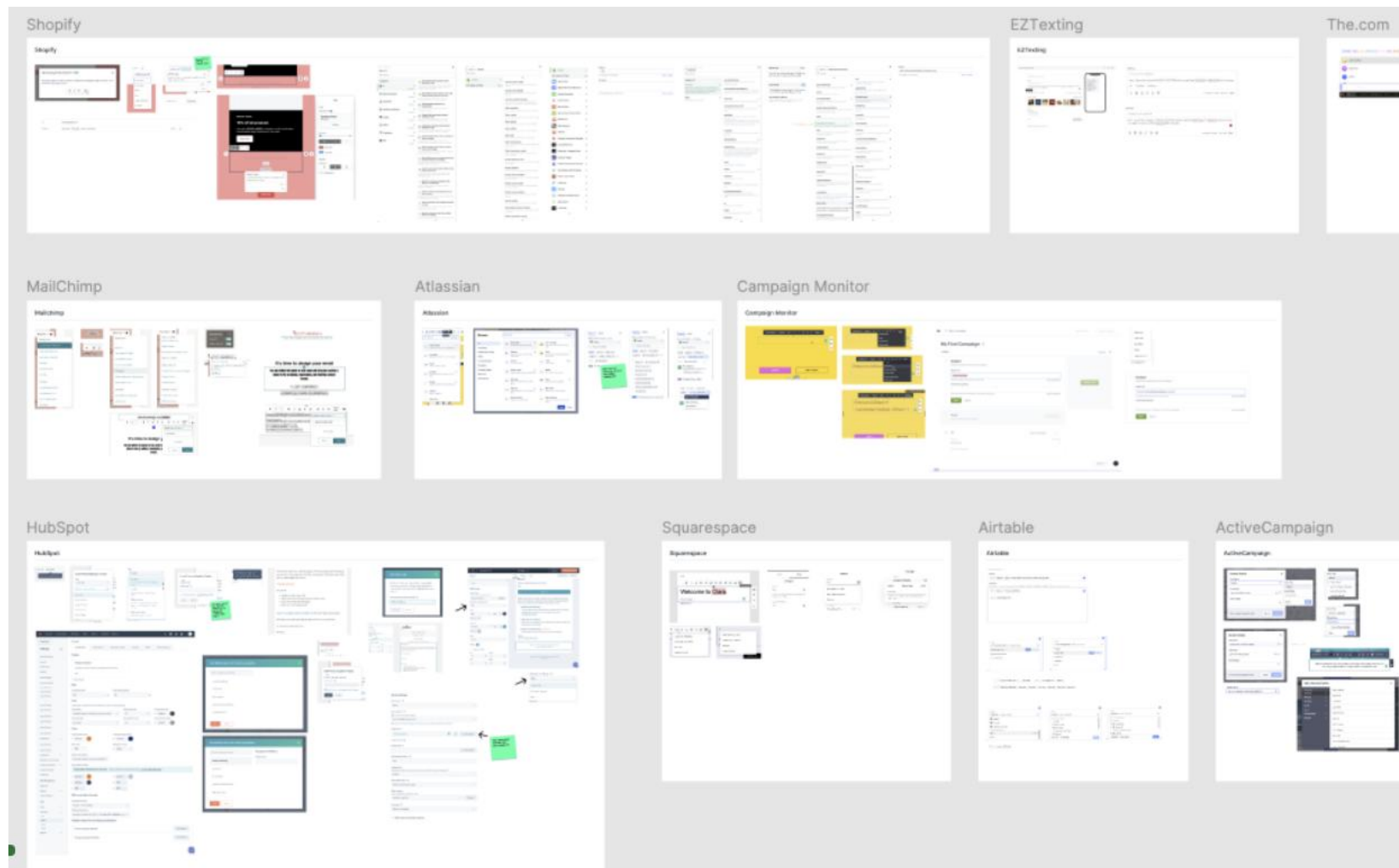
SOLUTION

Introduce an easy-to-use personalization menu that enables users to add dynamic content such as profile, event, organization, and custom properties.



Competitive Analysis

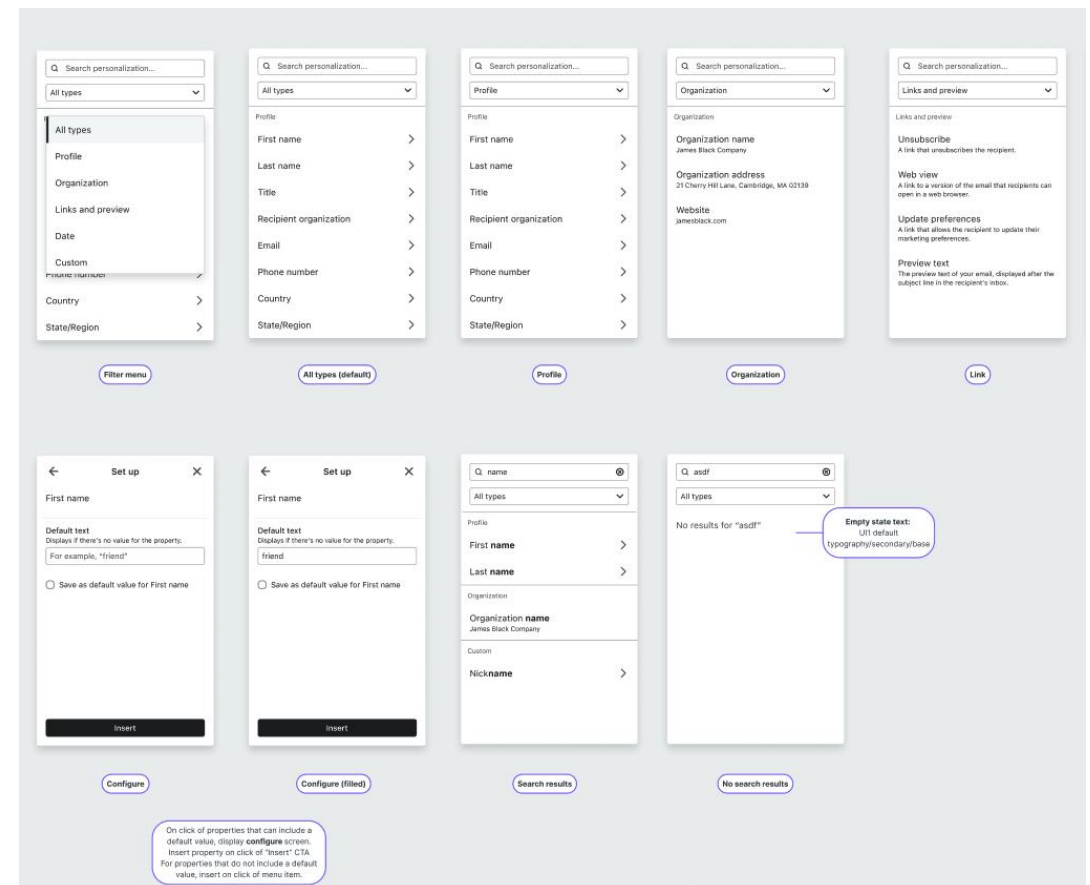
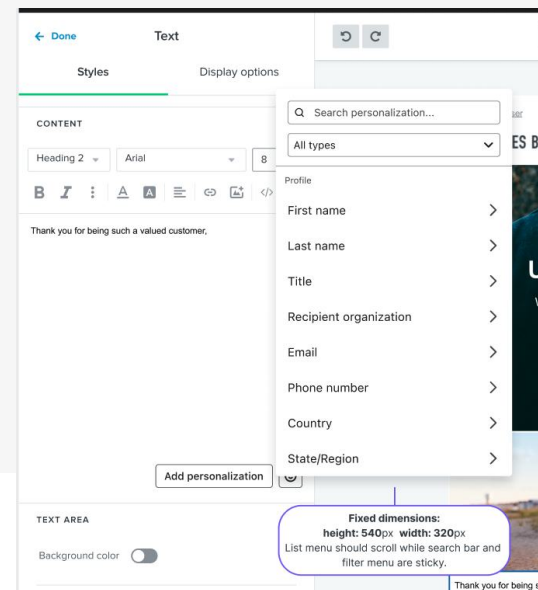
Research how competitors and other companies handle personalized content.



Version 1

Improvements to the current personalization menu

- Making the personalization menu **discoverable**
- Making the menu more **organized and easy to use** through labels, descriptions, and categorization
- Including **additional properties**
- Creating a better experience to input a **default value**



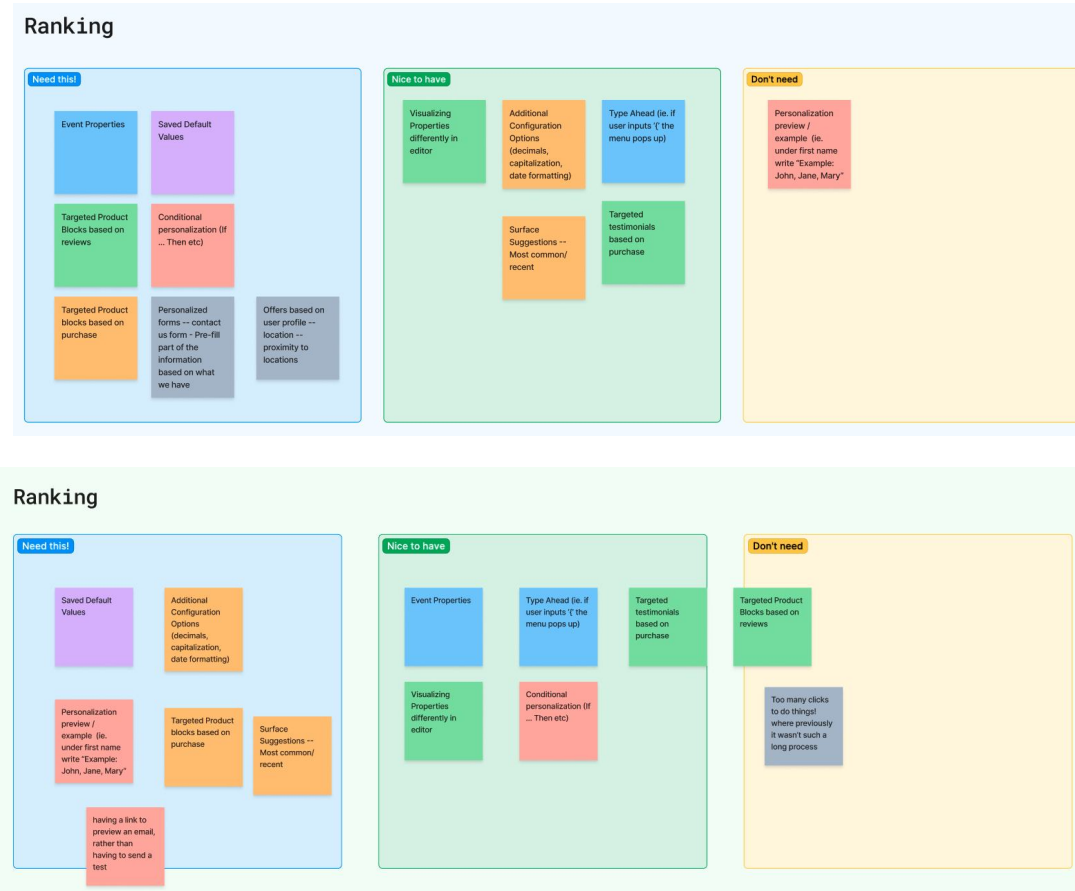
10 user calls with Klaviyo
customers of different size -
ranging from entrepreneur to
mid-market+

User Research

Conduct user interviews and concept test to gain a better understanding of key uses of dynamic content and our user's expectations on how to implement it.

PLAN

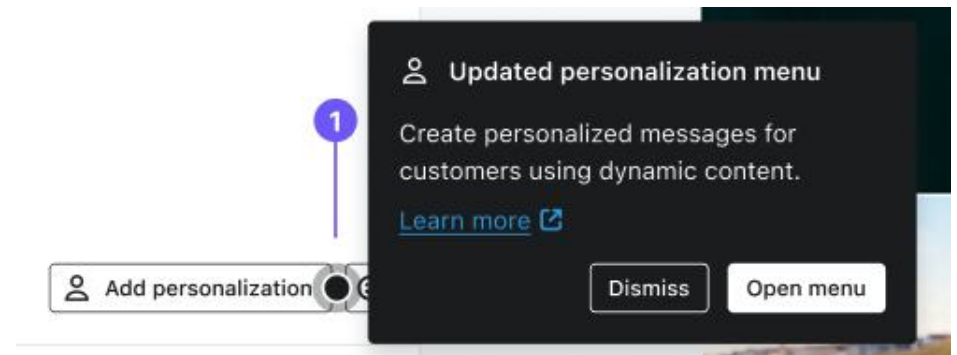
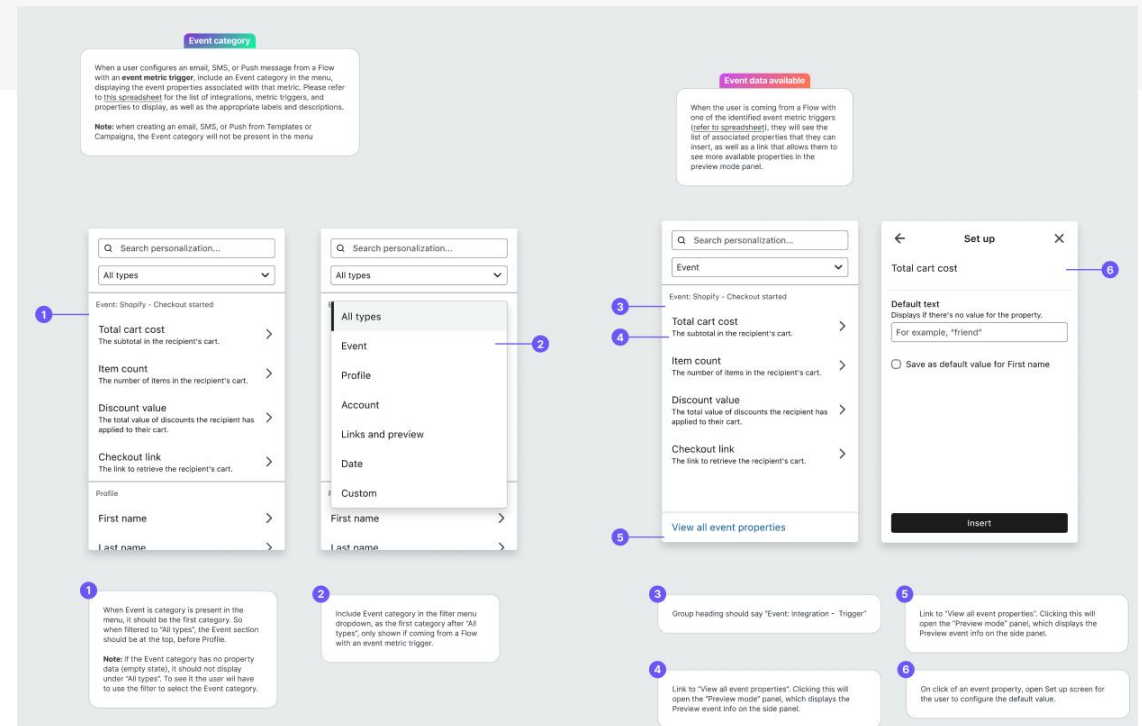
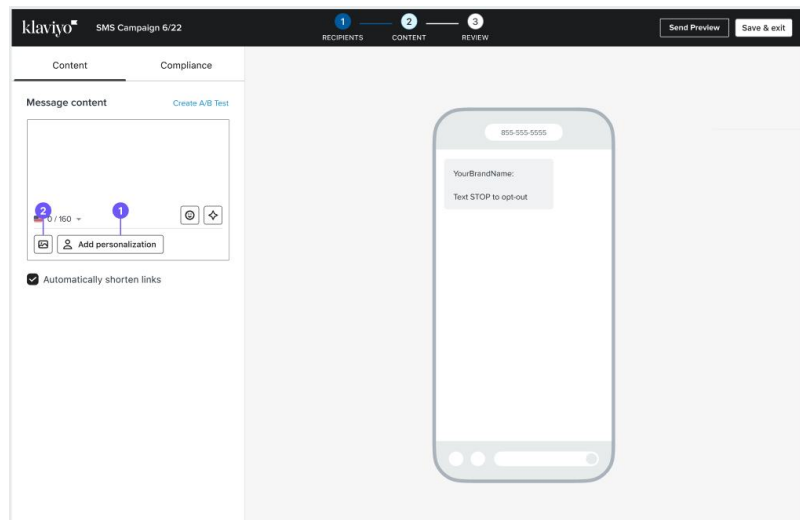
- ✓ **Intro**
Business and role, experience with the email editor, understanding of personalization.
- ✓ **Dynamic Content Questions**
What does dynamic content mean to you, do you use it and how, how would you expect Klaviyo to help you with it.
- ✓ **Concept Testing**
Expectation when clicking the Personalization menu, what do the options mean, overall thoughts on the experience.
- ✓ **Ranking activity**
Look through and rank the potential new features.



Version 2

Improvements to the personalization menu based on user feedback

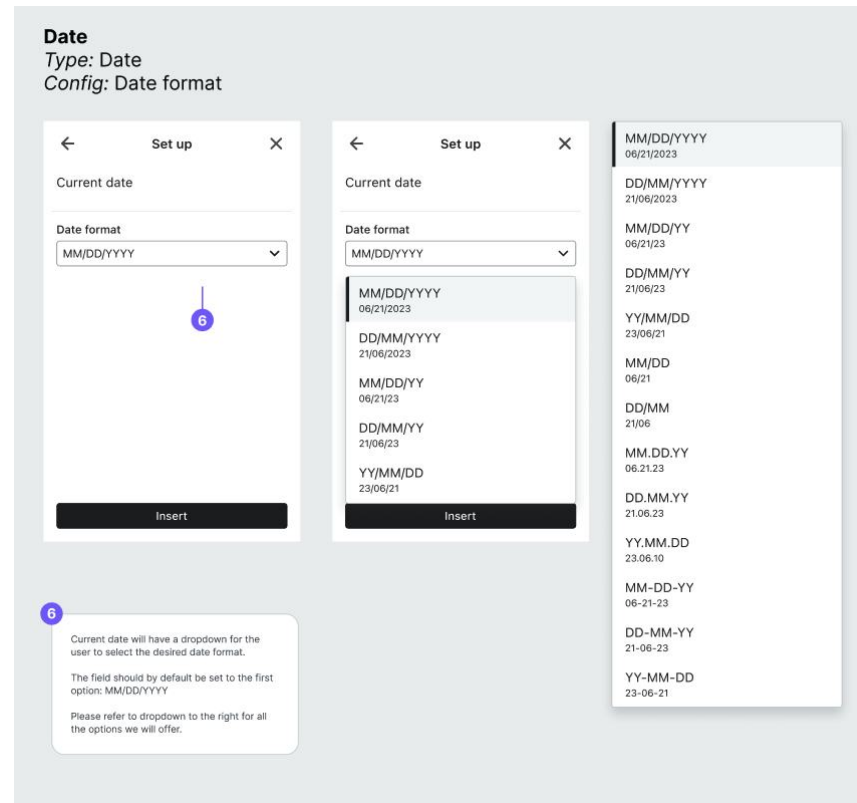
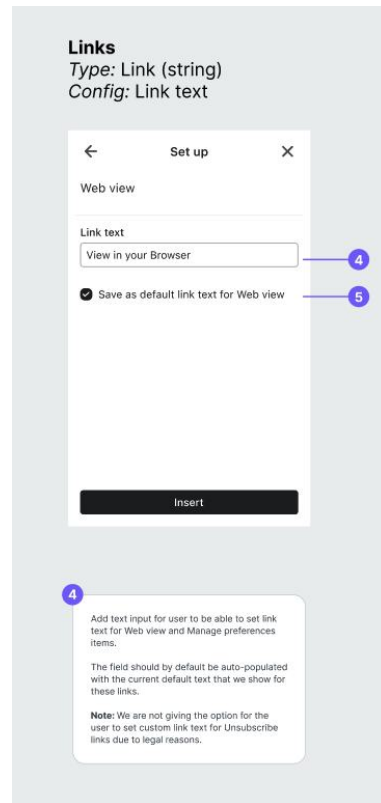
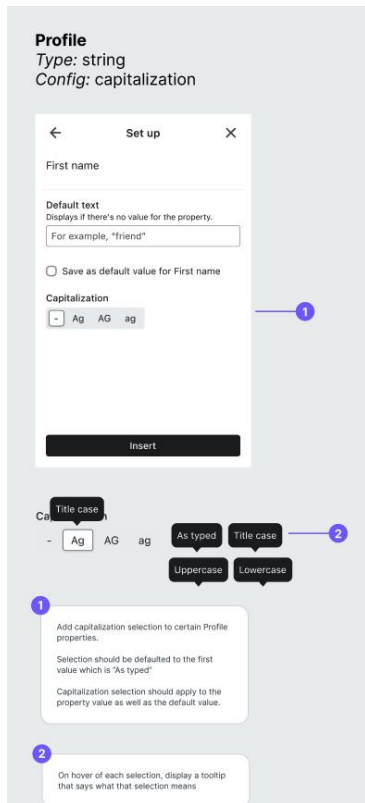
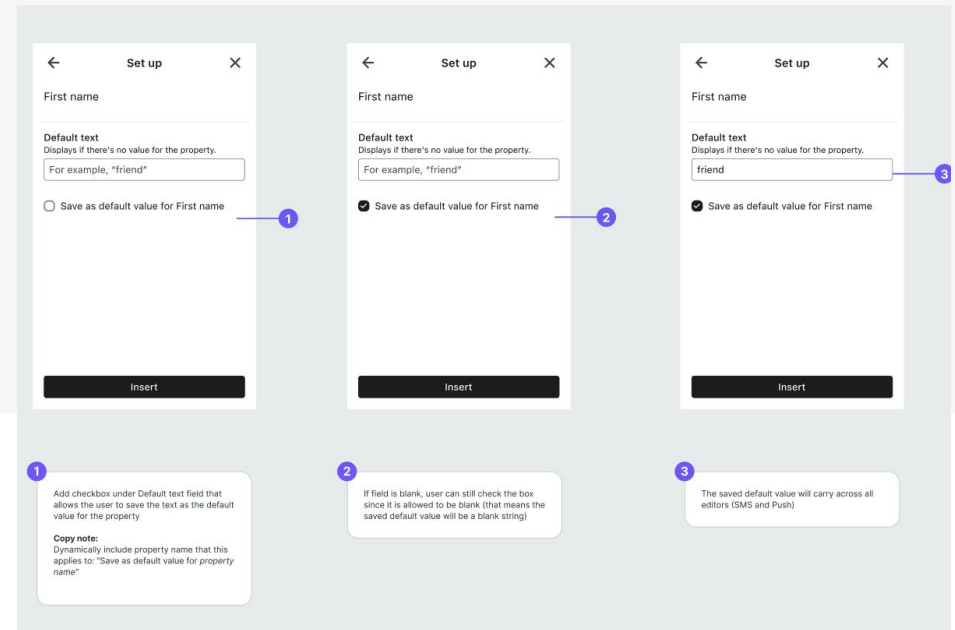
- Adding **event data** to the personalization menu
- Adding the personalization menu to the **SMS and PUSH** editors
- Improving **discoverability** through in-app guidance



Version 3

Additional improvements to the personalization menu based on user feedback

- Ability to **save default value** for future use
- Property **configuration options**: capitalization, link text, date format



Handoff and Outcomes

Handoff process for design and engineering + post-release outcomes

DESIGN REVIEW

Design review before engineering handoff includes review by lead researchers, content team, design systems, and leads (manager, pillar lead, VP).

ENGINEERING HANDOFF

An annotated file, prototypes, and a meeting to review product specifications and walk through final designs with the engineering team.

RELEASE PLAN

- Work with tech writers on updating help documentation
 - 30-60-100 release
 - Collect NPS and user feedback
 - Prioritize features for future iterations
-

POST -RELEASE OUTCOMES

- Marked decline in Django-related support tickets
- Marked increase in customers using dynamic content in their emails
- Positive qualitative user feedback

PROJECT 2

EDITOR LIBRARY CONVERSION

Massive overhaul of our editor-specific component library and code.

Overview

Overhauling the components throughout our email template editor.

PROBLEM

The components used throughout our email template editor are extremely outdated legacy designs and code. When we introduced our Ascent design system a couple years ago and began converting our product - the email editor was overlooked as many of the components needed were not readily available in the new design system. This led to a very inconsistent and sub-par user experience, as well as bugs that come with old code.

SOLUTION

We created an “Editor Library” as a subset of our Ascent design system. This task was essentially creating a “mini” design system specifically for editors’ use. I worked with the design system team to design new components (atoms → molecules → organisms → templates) and interactions, and created a library, as well as redesigned all of the panels within the email editor to use this new library. I am continuing to working closely with engineering as they implement this conversion. The result is a more modern, intuitive, usable, and compact experience.

This screenshot shows the old Klaviyo email editor interface. It has a dark header with the Klaviyo logo and 'Page Title'. Below the header are tabs for 'Done' and 'Button'. The main content area is divided into sections: 'CONTENT' with 'Text' (SHOP NOW) and 'Link address' (URL); 'TEXT' with 'Font' (Georgia), 'Normal' style, '14 px' size, '#000000' color, and 'Letter spacing' (0 px); 'BUTTON' with 'Color' (#1155CC), 'Corner radius' (5 px), 'Border' (off), 'Drop shadow' (off), 'Inner padding' (10 px), 'Left / Right' (10 px), 'Title' (Fit to Text / Full Width), and 'Alignment' (left, center, right); and 'BLOCK' with 'Background color' (off), 'Padding' (9 px), 'Left / Right' (18 px), and a 'Full width on mobile' toggle.

This screenshot shows the new Klaviyo email editor interface. It has a light header with a back arrow and 'Button' title. Below the header are tabs for 'Styles' and 'Display'. The main content area is divided into sections: 'Button text' with 'Text' (SHOP NOW), 'Link address' (URL), 'Helvetica' font, '14 px' size, '#444444' color, and 'B I U S' formatting; 'Style' with '#444444' color, '5 px' radius, 'Fit to text' / 'Full width' buttons, and '15 px' padding; 'Border' with 'Solid' style, '1 px' width, and '#444444' color; 'Drop shadow' with '#444444' color; 'Block background color' with '#444444' color; and 'Block padding' with '9 px' and '18 px' padding, and a 'Full width on mobile' toggle.

Process

Design process and continuous work with engineering on implementation.

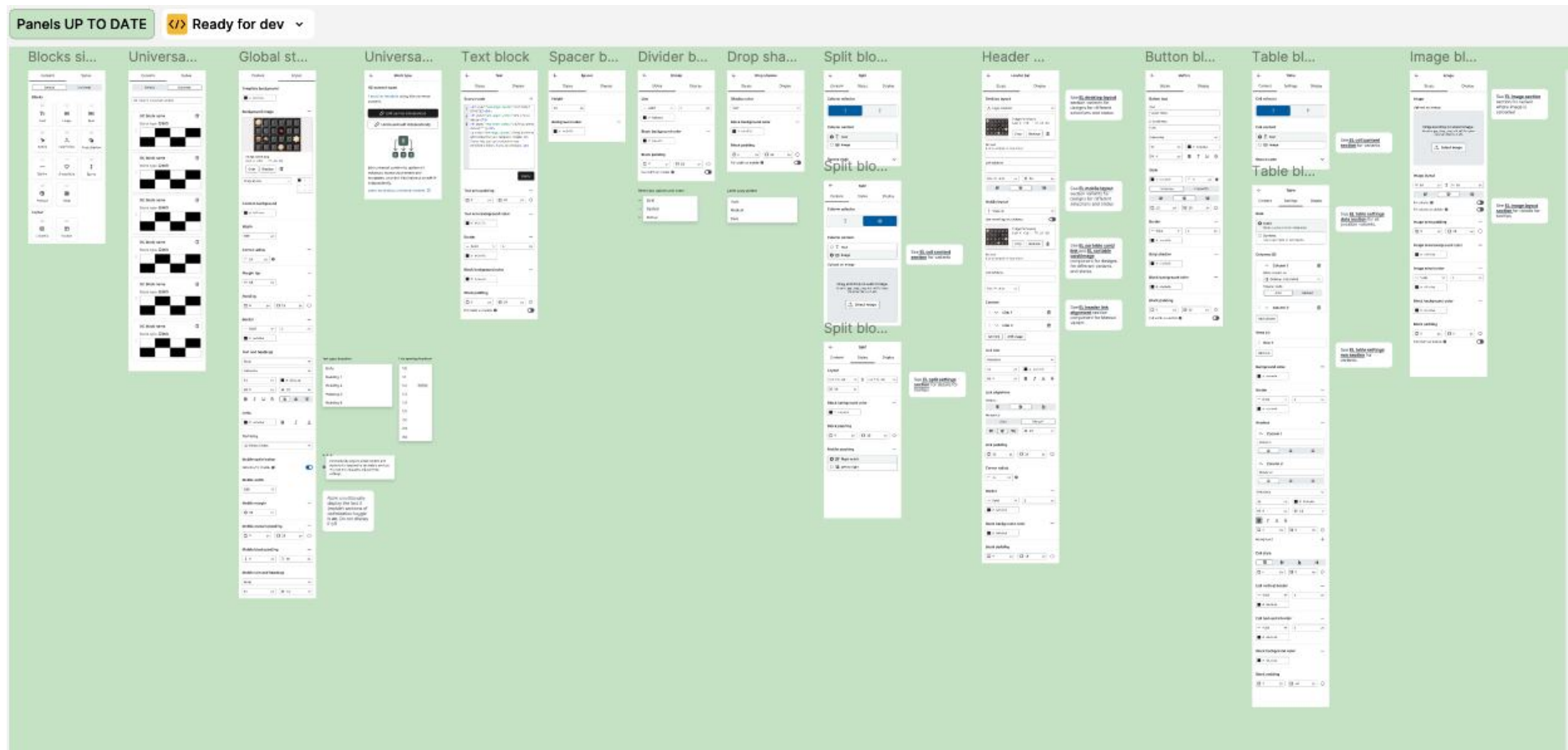
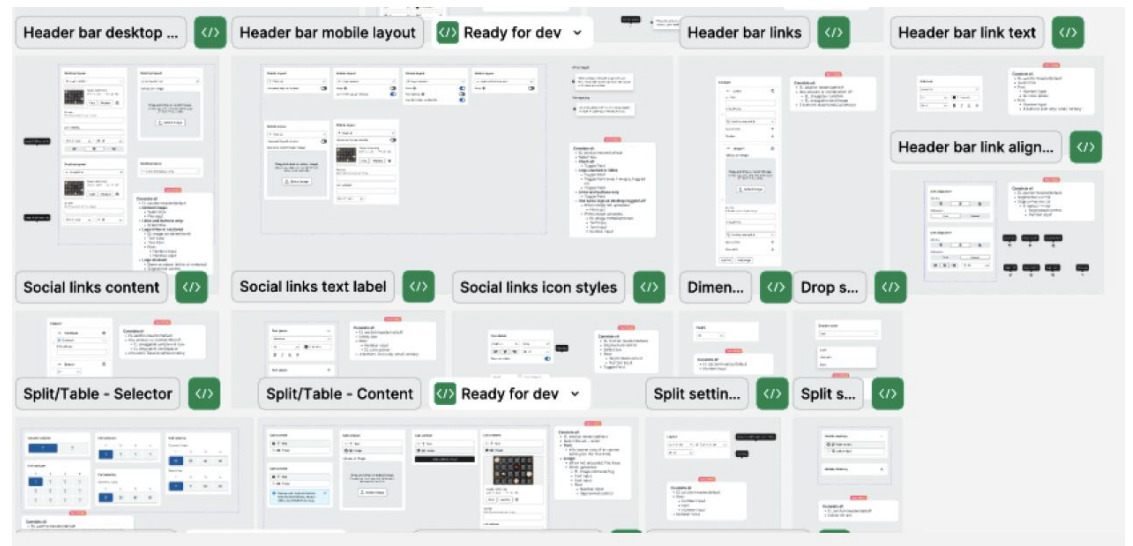
DESIGN

Create the Editor Library

- **Individual components** that are unique to the editor (ie. color picker, image container, grid selector, cell selector, sortable card). Worked closely with design systems to make sure these matched the style and behavior of Ascent components.
- **Composites** or “sections”: individual sections that will be made of up individual components (either Ascent or EL specific). Some will be reusable (ie. border, padding, color, text), and some will be unique (ie. layout options for different blocks, formatting options for different blocks etc.) Worked closely with content on label, description, and tooltip copy.
- **Full panels:** using the composites, put together all the of panels for all blocks found in the email editors.

IMPLEMENTATION

Continuously work extremely closely with “platform” engineers as they build the components and convert each panel. This includes ironing out design or technical hiccups that come up, and QA of each panel once it is implemented.



Future

Building an ecosystem of content editors.

UNITY ACROSS EDITORS

We currently have multiple content editors: email, SMS, Push, and Forms, as well as a new In-app messaging editor planned soon. There is much inconsistency across these editors, as well as the aforementioned issue of very outdated components and code.

We started this conversion/standardization initiative with the email editor, and are building the In-app editor from scratch using the new library.

It is an ongoing effort to transition the other editors to the new library. This will enhance uniformity in the content creation process in Klaviyo and ensure a smoother onboarding process for new editors being added to the system.

BENEFITS

1. It will be easier for users to use each of the 4 editors and work across them
2. It will be easier for the team(s) to maintain codebases, release features, onboard new team members, and scale product areas.

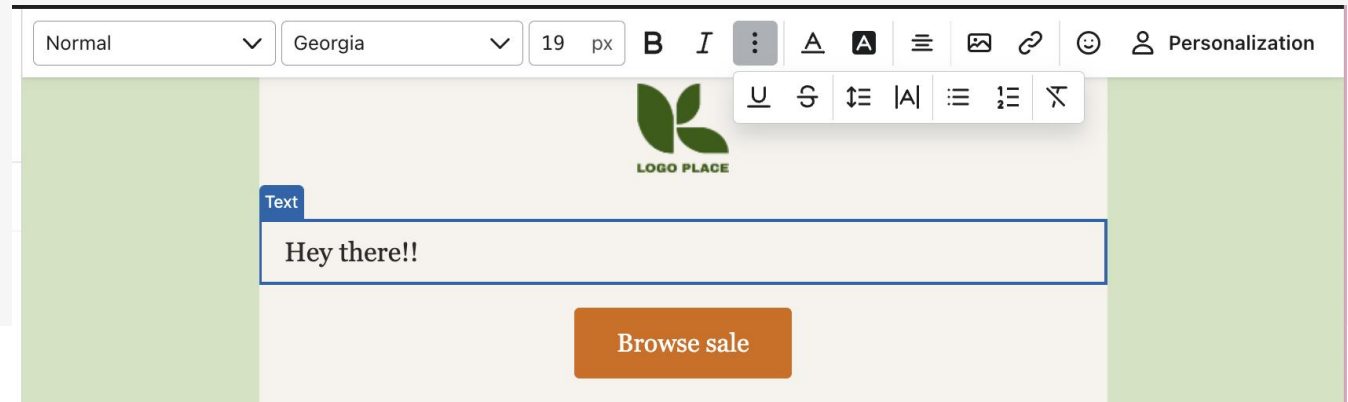
PROJECT 3

IN-CANVAS EDITING

Introducing in-canvas editing to the Text block in the email template editor.

Overview

New



PROBLEM

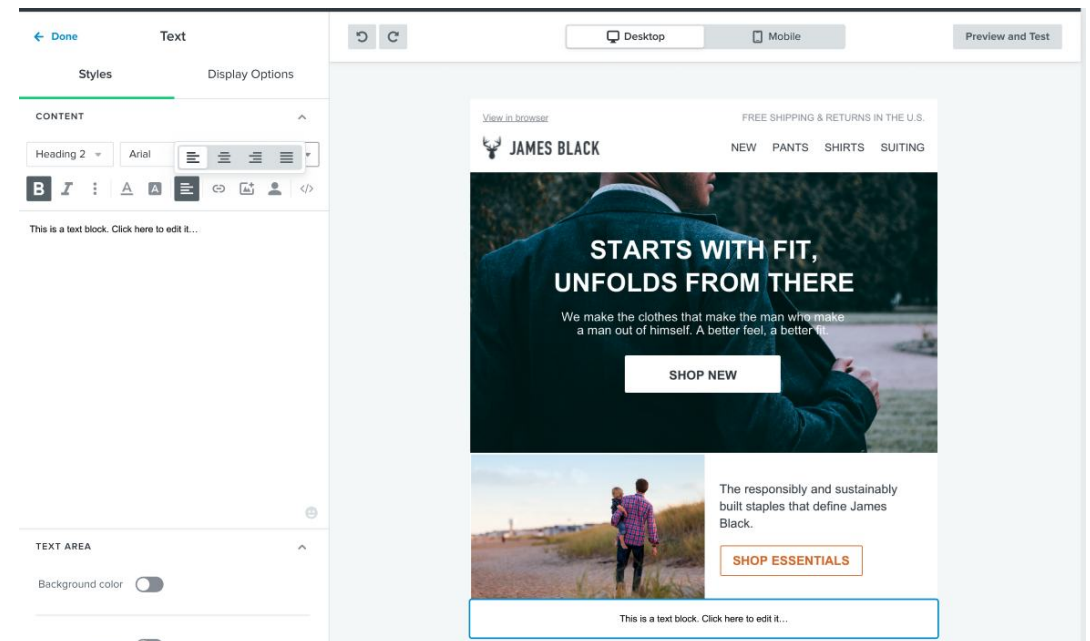
The current email editor poses a UX challenge, demanding multiple steps to configure content in a side panel for each block, rather than directly in the canvas. It also puts us behind competitors (like Mailchimp, Flodesk, Hubspot, Constant Contact) and other heavily used applications (like Canva and Google Docs).

Introducing in-canvas editing, starting with the most frequently used text block enhances usability and supports the design principle of proximity.

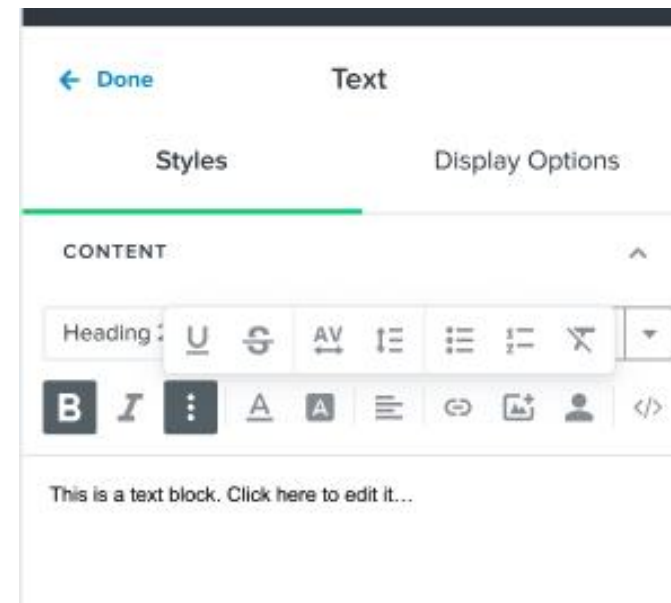
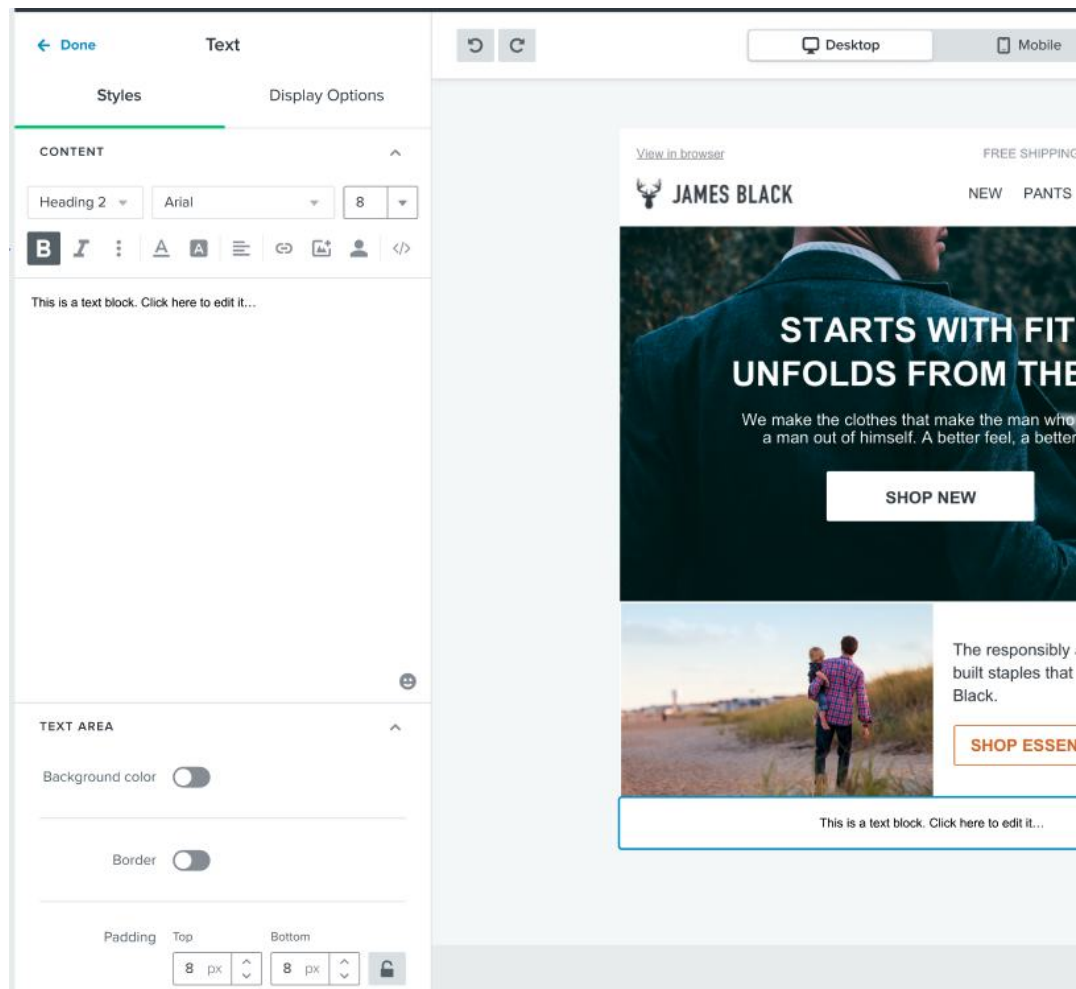
SOLUTION

Introduce text writing and editing directly in the canvas, with text styling controls appearing close within reach of the editing space.

OLD



Current state

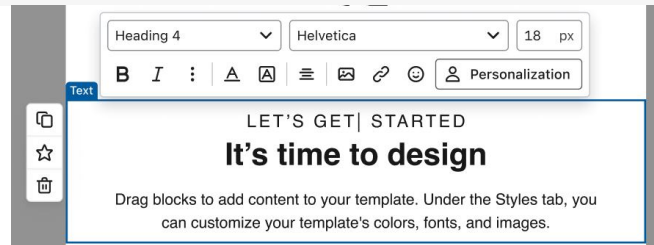


Overlays



Iterations

We went through multiple iterations as a result of user feedback to land on the ideal solution.



Concept Testing

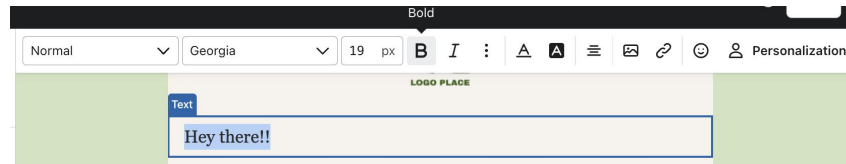
After doing competitor analysis, we concept tested 3 design options with various users.

Floating Toolbar

Based on the user testing, the “floating toolbar” design was the one we landed on.

Negative Feedback

When we released to 10% we got some negative feedback.



Follow-up

After going through the feedback and speaking directly with users, we realized we needed to make a change to our solution.

Static Toolbar

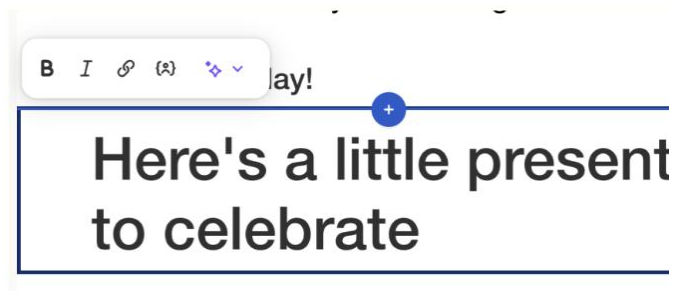
We quickly pivoted to the “Static toolbar” option. We started seeing a large decrease in support tickets and negative feedback.

Learnings

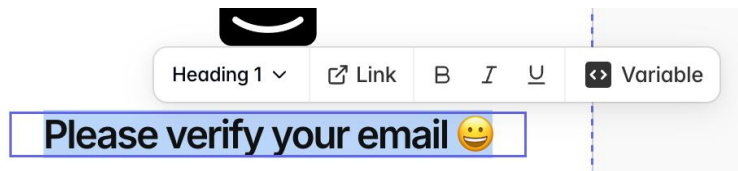
Sometimes concept testing doesn't fully capture the reality, and it's important to have a path to quickly iterate on solutions :)

Competitor research

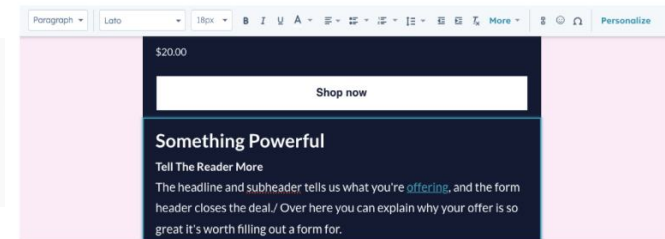
SHOPIFY



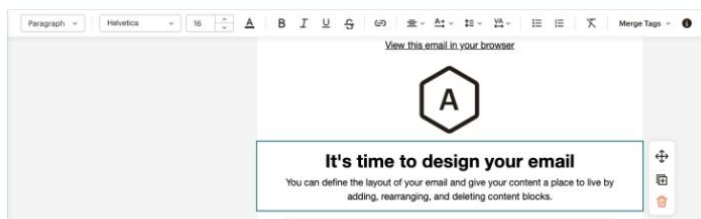
TABULAR



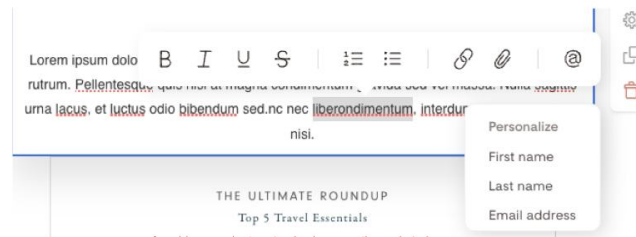
HUBSPOT



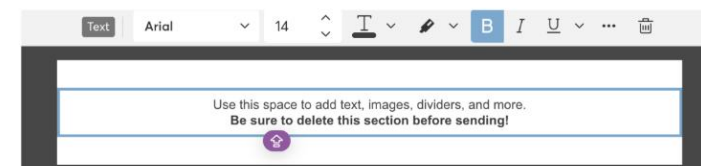
MAILCHIMP



FLODESK



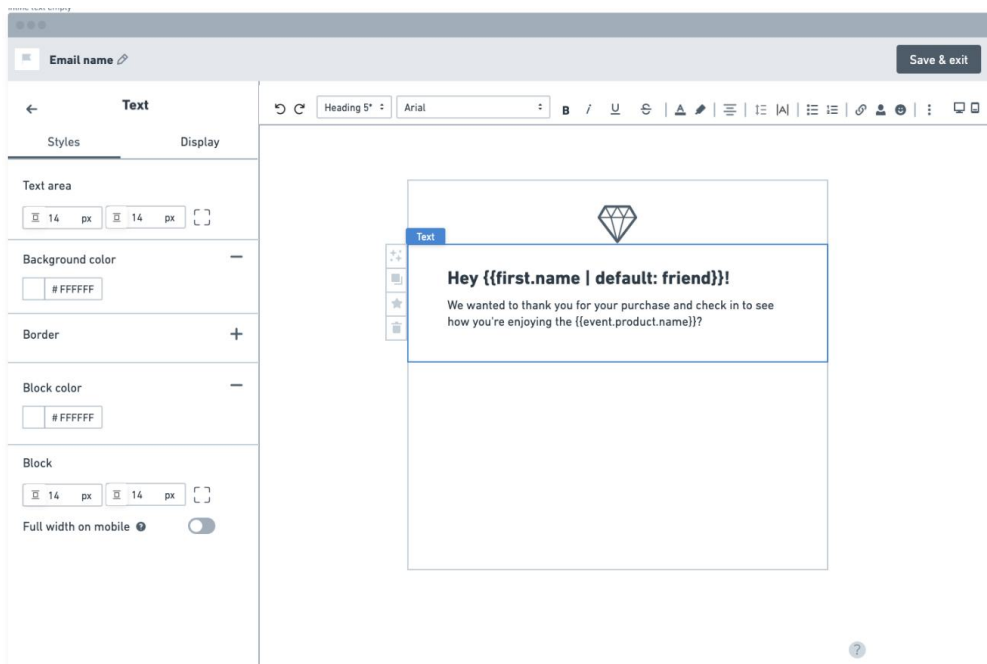
CONSTANT CONTACT



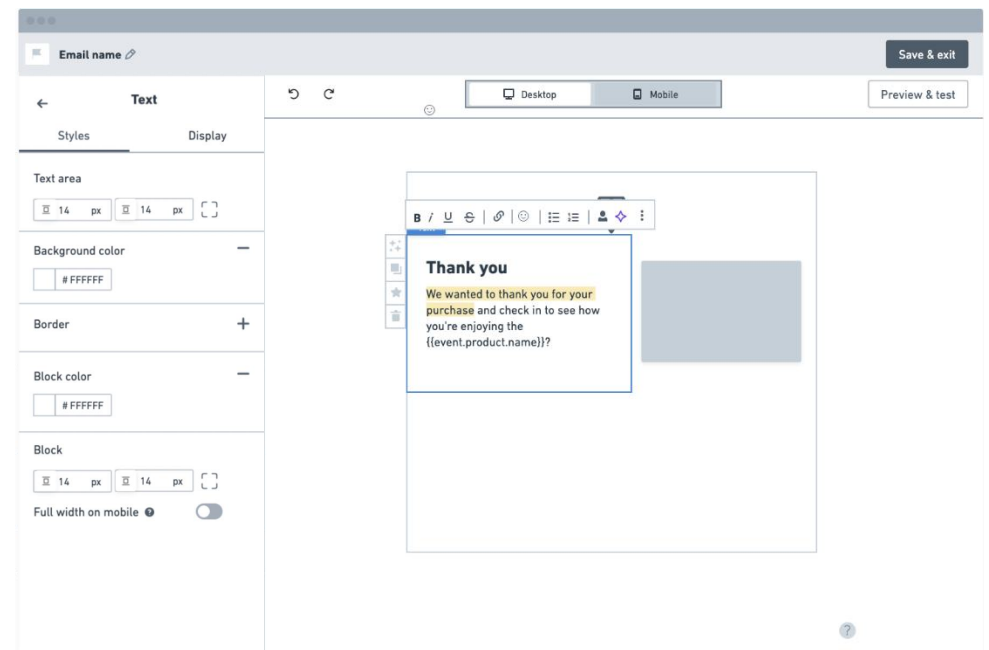
Concept testing

The research was aimed to help learn where users would expect to find options/settings while editing in-line text blocks. Users were asked about their ideal state and then shown concepts of options & settings presented.

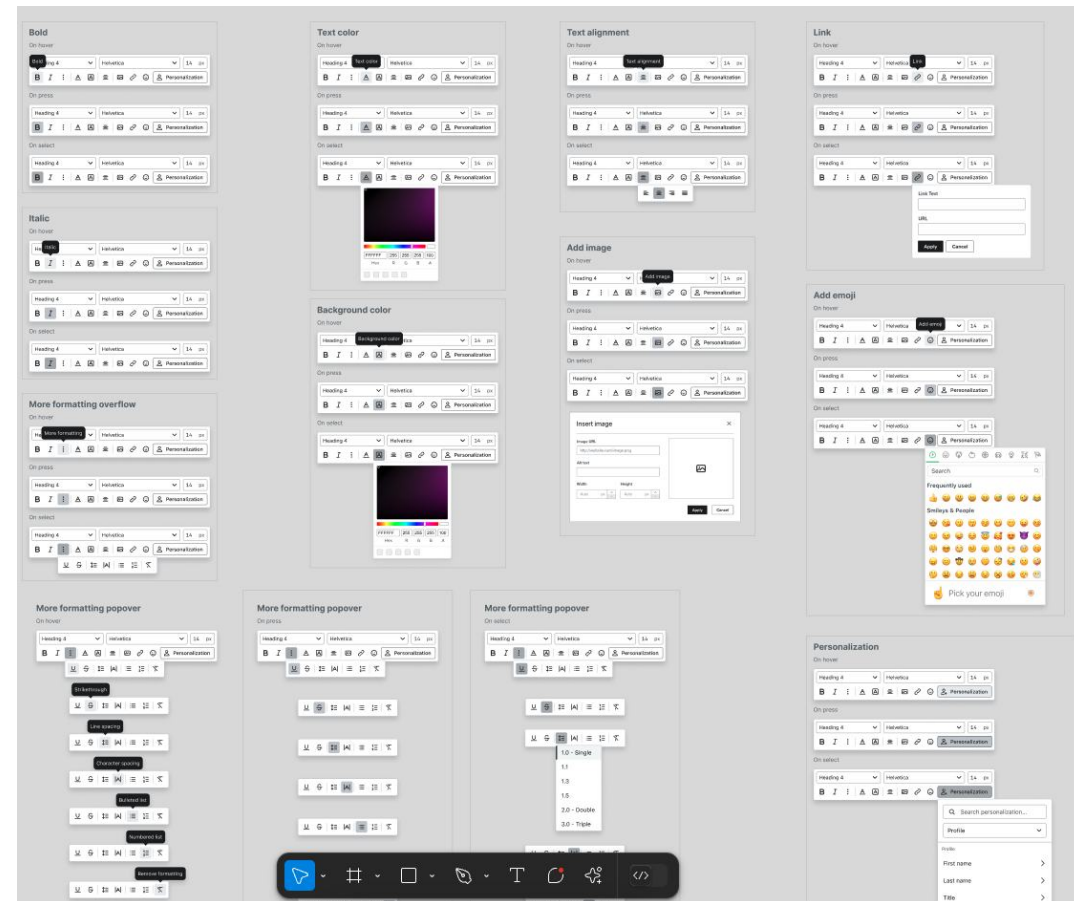
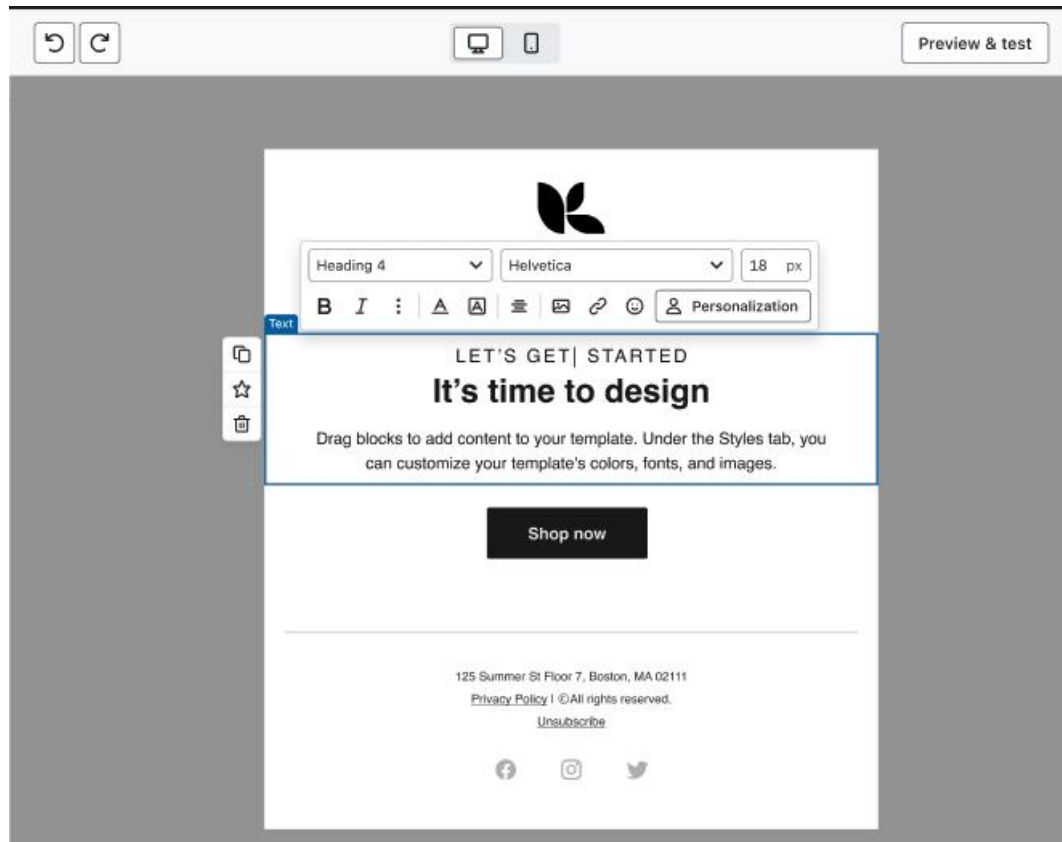
STATIC TOOLBAR



FLOATING TOOLBAR



Initial design



Limited availability (10%) - feedback

NEGATIVE FEEDBACK ON THE FLOATING TOOLBAR AFTER RELEASING TO LA

- Many support tickets and complaints that the floating toolbar was too intrusive and cumbersome - blocking the content of blocks users wanted to edit.
- Users expressed that they did not want the text editing options to appear directly where they are working, which is contrary to what users were saying during concept testing.

Sometimes concept testing doesn't fully capture the reality of working within the product!

ADDITIONAL CUSTOMER INTERVIEWS

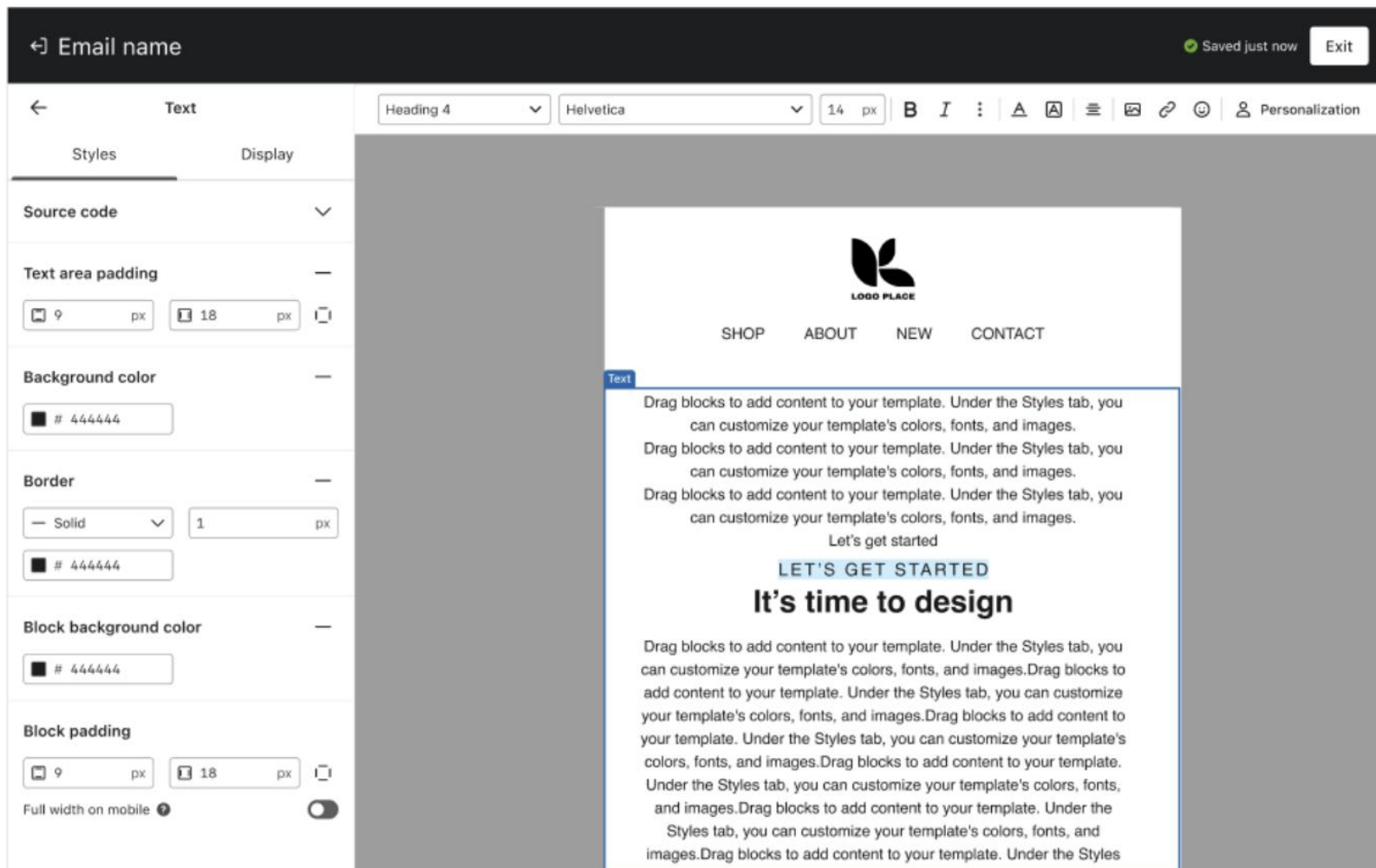
We reached out to some of the customers that submitted support tickets to speak with them directly.

All of them said that they liked that they could now type in the canvas, but disliked how the toolbar was in the way. They preferred the text editing options to be out of the way, but easily accessible, like at the top of the canvas (a few noted Google Docs and Canva as examples).

When showing the static toolbar as an alternative, they had really positive reactions

Pivot solution

We were able to super quickly pivot and switched to implementing the static toolbar solution.



We had a HUGE decrease in tickets, and very few users complaints about this experience, and released it to 100% of users.

We have since gotten positive feedback on the new in-canvas capability.

